VESSEL TRANSFER OPERATIONS

BASIC RISK ASSESSMENT GUIDE FOR ALL PERSONNEL

This guide covers the main hazards you will face during vessel transfers. **Read it. Know it. Follow it.**
If you are unsure about anything, **ask your Team Leader before you transfer.**

#	HAZARD	WHAT CAN HAPPEN	WHAT YOU DO
1	**Fall between vessels**	You fall into the sea. Drowning, hypothermia, serious injury.	✓ Wait for the Master to confirm safe conditions ✓ Use the pilot ladder – check it before you climb ✓ Three points of contact at all times ✓ Wear your lifejacket with light and whistle
2	**Vessel movement / wake**	You lose your footing and fall overboard or get thrown against the vessel.	✓ Hold on and brace when told to ✓ Only transfer when both vessels are stable ✓ Transfer stops if conditions get worse
3	**Crushing between vessels**	You get crushed between the boat and the vessel. Fatal or life-changing injury.	✓ Never stand between the two vessels ✓ Wait for the coxswain to say it is safe ✓ Stay clear until the transfer point is confirmed
4	**Pilot ladder failure**	The ladder breaks or comes loose. You fall into the sea or onto the deck.	✓ Check the ladder is properly rigged before climbing ✓ Report any damage – frayed rope, broken rungs ✓ Do not use a ladder you are not happy with
5	**Bad weather**	Wind, rain, and swell make the transfer dangerous. Higher chance of falls and injuries.	✓ Transfer only goes ahead if Master and Coxswain agree ✓ If conditions change, tell your Team Leader ✓ Transfer will be stopped if thresholds are exceeded
6	**Wet or slippery surfaces**	You slip on a wet deck or ladder. Broken bones, head injury, fall overboard.	✓ Wear non-slip footwear – always ✓ Wear grip gloves for ladder climbing ✓ Check the deck and ladder for water before you step
7	**Falling equipment**	A bag, case, or weapon falls and hits someone below. Serious head or body injury.	✓ All kit in bags or secured with lanyards ✓ Pass equipment hand to hand or by tag line ✓ Never throw anything during a transfer ✓ Clear the area below the ladder during equipment moves
8	**Wrong or missing PPE**	No lifejacket, no helmet, wrong gloves. You are not protected if something goes wrong.	✓ Check your PPE before every transfer: lifejacket, helmet, gloves, footwear ✓ Do not transfer without full PPE ✓ Report any damaged or missing PPE

#	HAZARD	WHAT CAN HAPPEN	WHAT YOU DO
9	**No safety briefing**	You do not know the plan, the risks, or what to do in an emergency.	✓ Attend the pre-transfer briefing – every time ✓ If no briefing happens, ask your Team Leader ✓ Know the abort signal before you start
10	**Fatigue**	You are tired, slow, and make mistakes. Higher risk of falls and poor decisions.	✓ Tell your Team Leader if you are too tired to transfer ✓ Get rest before transfer operations ✓ No one should transfer if they are not fit
11	**Poor communication**	Wrong timing, wrong position, nobody knows what is happening. Accidents happen.	✓ Radio check before every transfer ✓ Know the hand signals ✓ Listen for the abort call
12	**Poor lighting (night)**	You cannot see the ladder, the deck, or the hazards. Missteps and falls.	✓ Carry a head torch on night transfers ✓ Transfer area must be lit before you start ✓ Report if lighting is not good enough
13	**RHIB overloading**	Too many people or too much kit. The boat sits low, takes on water, capsizes.	✓ Coxswain decides the load – do not argue ✓ Multiple trips are safer than one overloaded trip
14	**Man overboard**	You or someone else falls in the water with no immediate rescue.	✓ Know the MOB alarm and recovery procedure ✓ Rescue equipment must be at the transfer point ✓ If someone goes in, raise the alarm immediately

STOP WORK – YOU HAVE THE RIGHT

If you believe the transfer is not safe, you must stop and speak up.

No one will be punished for refusing an unsafe transfer. Tell your Team Leader. If they do not listen, contact the Group Compliance Director directly.

Full risk assessment: SM/HSE/RA/002 – Vessel Transfer Operations v1.0
Related SOPs: Vessel Transfer SOP (region-specific) | SM/HSE/PRO/001 – Hazard ID & Risk Assessment
Questions? Contact the Group Compliance Director or QHSE Manager

YOUR WATCH. OUR STANDARD.
Assess. Report. Deliver.